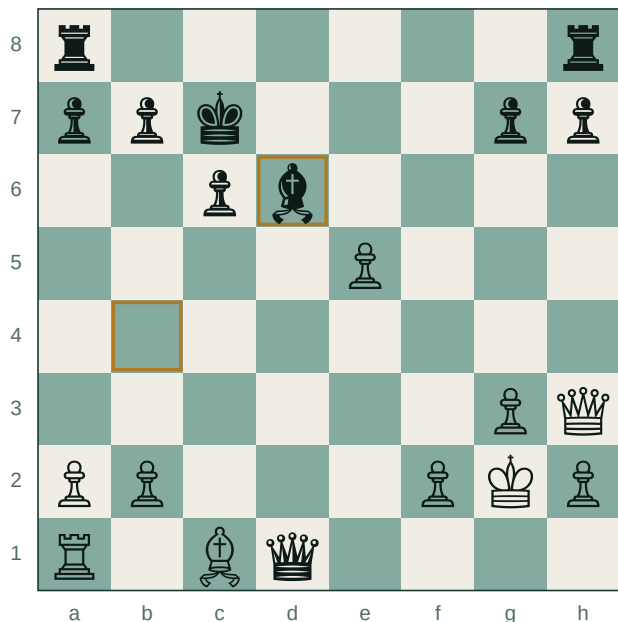


Pins and pressure: White, move 25

Pins and pressure

White to move



Previous move: 24...Bxd6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

25. exd6+ Qxd6 26. Bf4 Qxf4 27. gxf4

25.exd6+ Check restricts Black to 5 legal replies here. The move also takes the bishop on d6. Recorded reply: **25...Qxd6**.

26.Bf4 The bishop moves from c1 to f4. Recorded reply: **26...Qxf4**.

27.gxf4 The pawn captures the queen on f4.

At the end, nominal material is White 19 / Black 15 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +8. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +8: the balance goes from -4 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pin limits a piece because moving it exposes a more important target. A pin to the king restricts legality; a pin to another piece changes the practical cost of moving.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

The defending king is on c7. Geometrically undefended: queen on d1. Check for tactical protection.